

Um, what do we want to talk about? I want people to follow us on X. >> Yeah, Anukica's really been on the social media grind. We have reinvigorated our desire to get more followers. >> Yeah, I'm sorry if you haven't been seeing my TikToks. I've been really bad about them. I will be back on this week. >> She's been working till like 1:00 a.m. every day. >> It's okay. Open evidence. I love you. >> Yeah, she loves you. At least when you work late, like you're helping the doctors of America. >> That's what I tell myself. I'm like >> that's what I used to tell myself at FA. >> Yeah. >> Yeah. >> Well, the thing is like especially if you're like especially if things go down after hours, those are the people that really need it, right? Cuz it's like some emergency situation. >> Oh, >> that is actually really stressful. >> So like like when it's after hours, we treat it like with just as much urgency as on hours. Even more because it's like technically harder questions. It's not even the international population. It's like the US doctors that work here late hours. >> Wow. >> I never thought about that. >> Yeah. >> Other than that, we just impromptu decided we're going to go to Austin next weekend. >> Oh, yeah. We're excited. >> Yeah. >> We're going to take a little vacay. >> A little I was going to say brand trip, but it's not a brand trip. >> It's not. It's our self-funded brand trip. >> It's our self-funded brand trip. >> If you're a Brandon, you're listening. >> No, I'm excited. It'll be fun. I feel like I need a vacation. I haven't been anywhere since um Thailand. >> Oh wow. >> Is that true? >> I've been in a different city like every week. >> Yeah. >> Yeah. Atlanta, Florida, Guatemala, Australia. >> Wait, a kill in Sydney's wedding video looks insane. It was insane. >> It's so pretty. It's like >> just like the most innocent, lovely thing in the world. >> Yeah. Yeah. Or maybe not innocent. I don't know why I called it. >> No, I get I get what you're saying. Yeah. >> It's just a very like beautiful and intimate. >> Yeah. Yeah, >> it was. >> Yeah. I feel like that's how I want my wedding to be. >> I think >> they don't think that's how your wedding's going to be. >> Yeah. Your wedding's not going to be anything like that. But >> I don't think any of our wedding like of the three of us, it would be Anukica's. Like it wouldn't be yours. >> But I want mine to be like that. Like I don't >> sure conceptually. conceptually like I don't want that many people there but I don't think I'll win my >> I feel like going to that wedding I was like this is what I want >> but I it's not what I'm going to have >> I want a huge rager I'm so excited for my future wedding I'm excited for your future wedding I'm so excited for both of your weddings when we get into that era we're going to go on trips and okay we're like really again we always talk about this we're not close to it >> but you don't have husband >> well Pri and I are trying and our first step is that we've gotten on known, which is an AI matchmaker that our friend Celeste started. We had her on the pod, actually. So, some of you might have heard our episode with her. And if you use code get the check, you get your first date for free. And if you're wondering, Anukica, why do I have to pay to go on a date? I'm a girl. Or maybe you're a guy. Our audience is pretty split. That's something we're proud of. The reason why is because basically like Hinge, you have a subscription and then they're incentivized to have you be a customer, per se, for as long as possible. versus for Celeste, they make money when you go on dates and so they actually have the right incentives. And if you're going on a lot of dates and still not finding someone at that point, it's out of anyone's hands. >> Well, I was going to say the people they set you up with was like actually legit. Like >> say like they did a pretty good job picking. >> I was surprised. I was like, "Wow, if I was not single, I'd Or sorry, if I was not in a relationship, then sorry." >> No. Yeah. Honestly, like the the guy they set me up with was a guy I had already been on a date with, but like >> he's a he was a great guy. >> He was a great guy. Like I feel like on paper he was really tall, really

nice. >> He definitely doesn't listen to this, so it's irrelevant. >> Yeah. Identified Priya as a red flag in the first hour. So very astute. >> He did that. Yeah, >> he did say that. >> Anyways, use code get the check. >> Yeah. Yeah. Uh, welcome back to Get the Check. I'm Maya. I'm Anukica. >> I'm Pria. >> Wow, that was fun. Okay, we have a fun lineup for you. So, to start off, we're going to talk about data centers. So, data centers obviously are used for AI um in order to run the models and they've been a big topic of conversation this week. Bernie Sanders and AOC proposed the artificial intelligence data center moratorium act back in March. Um and there's been basically a huge debate about this on X and we're going to get into both sides of the arguments. The second is that um Trump and Xi Jinping met at the summit in Beijing. Um and this is really a big monumental moment because it's been the first time a US president has visited China um this officially in like what last 10 years or something like crazy. Yeah. Um and so we're going to talk >> Yeah. It's like the first time he's been there at all. >> Yeah. Yeah. So, we're going to talk about um exactly what they talked about in their meetings and what both the US and China have learned from like what I guess like what the media has told each of those individual countries from that meeting um because they're looking to stabilize the US and China relationship. And finally, for our last segment, we're doing a get the check segment. We have Amano on and Ammono is the um company focused on creating \$20 hearing aids and we're going to have their co-founder Arish on. And it was a really fun segment to film because hearing aids are very very expensive. They're upwards of four to \$5,000 and so being able to price something at \$20 is really neat. Yeah. >> Yeah. We can start with data centers. Basically, it came back up in the news because Gary Tan basically responded to the bill that AOC and Bernie Sanders put out, like Maya was saying, basically slamming everything that they were having to do, being like, "You guys are the people that said you want more employment in the United States." And this is exactly what that's doing. And you guys are basically putting a pause on this because essentially what they want to do is that they want to prevent AI driven job displacement. They want to require union labor for data centers. They want to do all of these things and put these basically safeties in place to make sure that they're looking out for the American people. And we can get into like both sides of that argument, but that's the reason that it came up again because this was proposed back in March. And I don't think it's necessarily picked up steam per se, and I don't think anyone expects it to be passed in either like the Senate or the Congress. It's more just like political signaling of this is what they want to do and like make sure they get the word out there. Um and Elon responded, other people responded. So it's really big news. >> Yeah. Specifically, the ha the act wants to halt all new expanded AI deniators greater than 20 megawatts until Congress has passed a national AI safeguard or agenda, >> which is pretty much all of them. >> Yeah, 20 megawatts isn't much. Um so of course like you will see like um Elon, Sam Altman, Dario, all these people who are invested even like Jensen um who are invested in the AI data center buildout speak out against this. But yeah. >> Yeah. Well, every single person. >> Yeah. Anyone from like the AI bubble to that benefits from the AI bubble. But yeah. Um and specifically Sanders basically says that the AI buildout is driven by billionaires, but 60% of Americans live paycheck to paycheck. And AOC also talks about how utility bills have jumped 267% um because a single AI facility can pull power equal to 100k homes. >> Yeah. And I will say the opposition to data centers is pretty bipartisan with seven out of 10 Americans saying they don't want a data center built near them. >> Yeah. >> I think part of why it's come back into the news is just because of how many protests have been

going on as new data center buildouts start in different cities. And there was I'm trying to remember the name of the city, but recently I saw one on >> Missouri, right? >> Was it Missouri? Yeah, >> I think it's Ferret. >> Okay. Where like literally they couldn't even hold the town hall where they were deciding on if they wanted it or not. They had to do it on Zoom because there are so many protesters. >> Yeah. And I think when you think about it from like an like if you think about it from a very middle of America normie perspective, like you let's say most of these jobs are 9 to 5 like labor affiliated jobs. So maybe you're a mechanic, maybe you're a teacher, maybe you're a cash register person. Um the question I feel like we should be asking is like is AI needed for these people like is isn't Google enough? Like I don't really think a lot of what CL like what a lot of what Anthropic and OpenAI have built in the last year specifically around coding models is useful to any of these people. And so then if you're saying, "Okay, well, we're going to put a AI data center in your town and your electricity is going to go up and they're not even benefiting from this technology or they don't feel like they're benefiting from this technology. How can you blame them?" And so I think it's it's very natural to understand like why these towns are against AI because like they are not the people that are going to benefit from AI because these tools at least in the beginning because they don't know how to use these tools. it's not going to fit into their everyday workflow, especially if their job is like primarily physical labor. >> Well, and I don't even think it's about using the tool versus not. Like I feel like, yeah, that's a component where like if they saw AI in their day-to-day workflow, they might support data centers more. But I think at the end of the day, it's just a difference between like, yeah, sure, you might be creating jobs in a city. But a lot of these data centers also know that they have a lot of leverage with local politicians because anytime there's a big construction project, it kind of reminds me of all the controversy around stadiums being created. stadium projects in Santa Cla that as a victory versus like other people are worried about the effects on the local population and it's kind of a mixed bag genuinely because it is probably going to bring jobs to the city but it is also like it was interesting researching it. It seems like it's pretty directly led to an increase in electricity prices. And even when you look at outages in certain parts of the country where like people might not like they might miss an electricity bill payment, which is like so much more fundamental than like what what tool are you going to use at work, right? Like they're like missing more payments by a slight amount. There's like a bunch of research into this. And it's funny like I'm pretty sure Gary Tan when he was talking about this cited the Brookings Institute. Yeah, he did. >> Okay. Yeah. And like literally the same Brookings Institute said that it's increasing people's electricity prices. And it's like like >> and they're also temporary jobs. Like the other thing that the Brookings Institute like report said was that they're temporary jobs. And so a lot of people were like, "Well, these are temporary jobs." But my take on that is that that's the nature of construction in general. Like construction is temporary jobs. It like moves whether it's a stadium or a data center or like whatever it is or like the highway project that happened. And I was looking into that because it is interesting >> because a lot of the same points came up back then when we were building that out. And the result of that is that yes, the work was temporary, but because of the economic impact that it had on even just like the creation of the suburbs and like being able to get out there and like all the jobs that were created because of >> the suburbs, >> the suburbs like that's like so fundamental >> to growing the economy. >> Yeah. >> And so I think that the same argument can be made here. Like I see both sides of it. I I definitely see both sides of it, but I do think that part of it is like it's not about what tool you're

using. It's like you're increasing the pie >> and so there's like other jobs. >> Well, the part the I guess the reason why I brought up like the whole toolbased argument is because if you're going to pay 276% of an increase on your electricity bill, you you should be also seeing some benefit to your life in like a free manner. So let's say it's like the AI answers from Google, right? Like you can sort of I guess like you can trace a very long chain between like okay I'm paying a little bit more for electricity but then Google's offering offering this like free product that makes my life better and more efficient and you get more of that utility back. I just don't think that the average person is actually getting any extra utility from the AI answers on Google. And so that's what I was trying to say is that like I don't think I can justify this 267% increase in electricity to these Americans. I just think the way that we think about things is so much more different because the ability to easily acquire which is what you were saying too like the ability to easily acquire knowledge helps us a lot for example like number one the podcast right but for most people it's actually undermining their own power in the labor economy so it's like what I'm trying to say is it's the reverse like AI getting better is like actually net negative to them said yeah I'm saying they're I'm saying they're not benefit off of Google giving better AI answers or whatever. >> Like what I'm saying is they're actually hurt by it, which is like even worse, right? Because >> Yeah. I'm taking a neutral stance on like the the implementation for AI and you're saying it's even negative. >> Yeah. Like I guess at least perception wise, people in the country definitely think AI is going to like replace everyone's jobs, right? And so the whole idea of like AI getting better is important for us to beat China or for us to succeed even domestically, like they just don't I don't think care about that. Um, okay. Okay, wait. Did you guys read about the Trump ratepayer protection pledge? No. >> Because because I'm like >> unclear on what the result of it is going to be basically in March because everyone like it's a fact that like people are paying more energy prices are going up. Like all of that is a fact and we know that. And so like Amazon, Google, Meta, Microsoft, all of these people signed this protection pledge basically saying that they will cover the the cost of anything >> that's increasing it as a result of data centers. And so they basically like have this pledge in place which like >> nothing has gone into effect which is why I'm also not like completely clear on how much it actually like will affect the American people. But I do think it's interesting that they signed something like that and it says that it's non-binding, but they essentially are saying that if there is an increase as a result of data centers, they will pay for it. And I don't think anyone's really talking about that. >> I didn't know that. I also would be like surprised if like the follow. >> Yeah, I was going to say >> and I agree with that too because I haven't really heard people talk about it. I don't know what you saw. >> Like basically the White House said that they're not the ones to enforce it. it's at the state level and I guess I also don't know for sure but it just seems like it's the same people regulating it that are striking the deal to begin with and to go back to what you were saying even about the highways I think that is the whole problem right where everyone agrees that infrastructure upgrades are necessary for the country and right now we're especially in this extremely tight race with China and that's like the perspective Silicon Valley is taking but the taxpayer subsidizing it Silicon Valley doesn't really have an answer as to why the taxpayer should should subsidize the creation of tools that automate their own jobs away. And then yeah, like Trump's pledge made sense to me. I was like, that makes sense. And I feel like that is even like >> the AOC and the Bernie moratorium. No one thinks that's going to happen. And so everyone thinks that they're just doing that to try to get more leverage in conversations like this, right? Like this

pledge. And this pledge seems really toothless, but I feel like there might be something that comes along down the line. And I could even see on the local level like because this pledge that Trump has is supposed to be enforced by the state where these protests the way that the state politicians or like council city council decides on it is they're like okay we promise you guys will enforce Trump's pledge in exchange we're going to pass the data center being here. Mhm. >> Another question I had was do you think that like I guess a lot of a lot of people have talked about like oh why don't you just like uh come up with like a rebate a rebate program or some subsidy program for the like the electricity bill being higher like at least the government um gives some sort of kickback to these like electricity facilities so that these like citizens pay less or whatever and I was wondering like why Bernie and AOC didn't propose that but I guess I'm answering my own question but maybe it's because they wanted to pro propose something even more drastic so that like they have a they have a seat at the table for the conversation and then they'll like come to the come to an agreement on some like subsidy. Is that an idea? I don't know. Do you get what I'm saying? >> Yeah. I mean I feel like the things they're proposing aren't actually more extreme than a subsidy. It's just that the headline of a moratorium on all the creation of new data centers is the extreme part. Right. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. But that's that's what I'm trying to say is like >> No, no, I know. I know. But I'm saying like >> that's not like the actual policy. Like the actual policy is like this. One of you guys had already said it which was around like unions and all of these other things. >> Well, the policy is that they have to halt creation of AI data centers until they like decide. >> Right. That's what I'm also saying. Yeah. Yeah. Like it's like the actual policy isn't the halting of the creation of data centers. It's like having the conversation around how they should be successfully implemented. But I guess to answer the other or like not answer it to discuss the other thing on subsidies, it seems like these data centers also have a ton of tax exemptions and are actually getting subsidized themselves. >> Oh, really? >> Yeah. >> Oh, I didn't know that. Say more. >> Like they're exempt from like a lot of typical taxes and that in the deals that they're striking with these cities, they like don't have to pay taxes on most cities. >> Wait, why? because it brings more jobs to the cities and like brings economic >> well that's like my understanding is like when big infrastructure buildouts happen then like a stadium or something like those are the types of deals that cuz it's like a it's a deal making process and so like I think there's probably a lot of politicians that like want the next big data center to be built in their city from a job perspective from a headlines perspective from a like right and so if the politician has an incentive for the data center to be built there and there's multiple cities they could go to. Like that's basically one of the ways you tell them that you let them be in your city. Even like with big tech centers like >> Yeah. Like AW Yeah. And that's like the whole problem where like politicians don't necessarily have the incentive of the average person in mind because they want to they want like tax investment in their city, but tax investment in their city isn't in >> the people. Yeah. >> Yeah. >> Yeah. >> Yeah. >> That thing is kind of crazy. What would you what would you propose like if you were AOC or Bernie and like you wanted to like >> I think you go after their like tax exempt status and basically say like private industry needs to be responsible for funding this >> and maybe you also go over like I think yeah like you do that and then I think there's a more longer term conversation the government's just failing to have which is like if we go through an economic labor revolution where there's some short-term loss of jobs like what does that look like what are we going to do? Are we going to do like universal basic income? Are we going to just like put more people

on welfare? Like I don't I haven't I don't even know who's like thoughtfully articulated what to do.

>> I don't think many people have. >> And I feel like I've asked people this like actual politicians or even like tried to read what people are doing online and I just don't think anyone really knows what to do. I just I feel like we should move towards stateowned or governmentowned like um this like utilities like similar to what Chroycott was saying about San Francisco. It's like when the government owns the power grid um there is benefits in that the power grid is not inaccessible to lower income people. Everyone has consistent delivery and power. Um and it doesn't have to be like it's not a bad thing paid for by taxpayer dollars. >> Yeah. Like no, no, no. Like you still pay the government for usage >> for usage, but you but the government is not making profit off of you. So there's no supply and demand problem. >> Yeah. And the government >> which is like what like Texas takes advantage of today. >> Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. >> I see. >> Yeah.

>> Yeah. >> But it's hard to get like 50 states of America across in like all the cities in each state to adopt that model. Like it's just infeasible to go after that. So then the other way you go around it is just subsidies. Yeah, >> but I do think that the the electricity being 250% higher is like a really bad thing. >> It's really bad. It's super high. And I was looking at like some of the stats around it too and they were honestly shocking. Like I didn't realize what a big percentage of people's income is spent on energy. But it said that for like lowincome residents, they spend 20% of their income on energy. >> That's which is crazy. That was like way higher than I thought it would be. Yeah. >> Um but I guess it makes sense. And on top of that, they have also called out like environmental concerns and health concerns. And there was a study done by someone at Carnegie Mellon, like an economist, and >> shout out. >> Shout out um and he found that there was \$25 billion per year in health and environmental damage literally because of like the air pollution. >> Oh wow. and the detriments to health, which is definitely a real thing that I think everyone tries to cover up time and time again, like whenever there's oil spills, um, or if there's things in the water that make people sick, like it's very it's a very real thing that happens. And so that is concerning for people that live in those areas. >> It's like, do you like do we think Gary Tan wants to live next to a data center? >> Exactly. >> Like, do you want to live next to data center? >> I I get what they're saying. >> No, no, I'm not saying it like to you. I'm just No, I'm not SAYING IT LIKE I WAS ON YOUR SIDE. NO, NO, NO, NO. I'm saying like I'm saying like we don't like what I'm trying to say is like even like Claude's biggest fan doesn't want to live next to like I'm not saying you like you specifically like I'm saying like no one hypothetical. Yeah. Like even the person that like sits every day at work and benefits the most like Gary Tan who has his whole Gstack built out like he he wouldn't want to live next to a data center either. It's just like the people benefiting the most from it are not like living in these cities where it would even be feasible >> where there's space. >> Yeah. >> What do you think Trump is going to do? Because Trump like always likes to appease both the billionaires and like the >> I think that's like literally what the pledge is aimed at. >> No, I know what the pledge is aimed at, but like let's be real like that's that's just like a band-aid like or >> I don't know if it's a band-aid if they actually subsidize it because Google, Meta, all these people like they are the ones benefiting >> Yeah. the most from the data center and so like whatever amount that they have to offset it could be worth it for them. I don't know what the economics of that looks like but it could be worth it to them. >> Like I listen to did you see Tucker Carlson and Kevin Olirri or Mr. Wonderful on chart? So, I think it's Ohio, like Kevin Olirri has a big data center build out that he's funding right now and he was on the Tucker Carlson show talking about it. And I feel like Tucker Carlson and his new podcast to

me is a really good gauge on what like maybe the average person's thinking cuz I even find myself agreeing with him. Like even though I don't politically and like all his comments on TikTok of his podcast are always like why like 2026 is so cooked. I'm agreeing with Tucker Carlson. Anyways, he was like like even he was the one that like interrogated Sam Alman about like um the death. But anyways, Tucker Carlson was like, >> "Okay, that's fine. Like we need to beat China. We need these data centers, but why should the taxpayer have to subsidize it via like rate hikes like basically all the things outlined in the pledge like why isn't private industry paying for that?" And Kevin O'Rourke had really bad answers. like he basically just talked about the benefits of building out a data center which was just not responsive. And then Tucker Carlson was like, "Yeah, you don't need to like explain that to me again. I'm just asking you like isn't it like he didn't use the word socialism but like isn't it socialist to like expect the government to build that out for you or like expect the taxpayer to do it >> and then they kind of just like didn't come to conclusion and I didn't watch the whole thing. I just watched a clip. But yeah, >> so I feel like to me if it had teeth that is kind of a middle ground, right? >> I agree. I guess I don't know if this is true about the highway project, but I feel like with the highway project like it didn't affect people like in terms of like a utility manager like costing them more. Like there's one part of the argument which is like it's not nice to live next to a data center and I agree with that. But then there's a second part of the argument it's like okay I actually just can't make ends meet. And that's like the part of the argument that I'm like really worried about. And I have never seen like a buildout like this that actually directly affects like the price of things being that high. Like a historical comparison or at least I couldn't find something like your utilities, your food goes up. Like nothing's consumed that much that like Americans need, you know? >> Honestly, I think the best example of it is just the process of gentrification where like PE firms in the past have bought up a lot of houses in neighborhoods and it prices people out of their rent price, right? And it's like why some people say that's like the most evil aspect of private equity. Well, I should put it in quotes, but like they like build they like buy I mean are about to get priced out of the city too. >> Literally like not joking. >> It's so bad. Like the the all the like what is it like this home went for 5 million over asking? Like what? >> Yeah, that that house went for 14 million. It was priced at seven and it sold for 14. Insane. It's probably an allcash offer too. But then like when private equity buys houses up like yes you get priced out of your rent but then you also get priced out of your neighborhood over time because then gentrification like all everything becomes more expensive. You get like the nicer cafes that come in. My push back on the highway point would be I feel like anytime I've read about any investment in transportation or infrastructure, whether it's like bridges, public transportation, highways, that all directly benefits the economy a lot because regardless of what job you have and the people that live there. >> That's what I'm saying. >> Because more people come to that area because there's an easy way to get there >> and it makes it easier for you to get to different jobs. Yeah. Like I just don't think it's a parallel argument at all. I fully agree. Yeah. That's why I was like his highways is not a good comparison. It's not actively hurting >> America. Yeah. >> Well, it's also just like the cherry-picking of things that he did, but then he also would like cite things that just like directly go against his argument. I was like, this is crazy. >> Okay, just go build your G-Stack in a corner, please. >> Actually, like all these conversations ever teach me is that people's intelligence in one area often does not cross apply. People are really bad at generalizing things like looking at the whole market. >> Like you'd think someone really smart at tech would be really smart at

politics and I actually just don't think you see that. >> Oh yeah, I agree. >> Okay. Oh, anyway, then we have Elon stepping into the picture and he's like, "Let's just build data centers in space, everyone." And that's his solution to everything, which is a good solution. Like >> I mean, if possible, >> if possible would be sick, but I think him similarly to like the conversation that you were referring to. I was listening to him talking to Darkees about it. Um, and Darke directly asked him like, "Okay, how are you planning to maintain GPUs in space? What happens if they break? What are you going to do to them? And Elon's answer to it was basically like, oh, I think they're pretty reliable and so that won't happen. Like, it's kind of just like all of these are non-answers to like very real >> Yeah. >> questions. And he was like, I think it's going to be there in the next, what did he say? 30 months. Something crazy. I was like, okay. >> Wait, but project Suncatcher is like a timeline of 20 years or something. >> No, it's 202. >> Well, said that he thinks it's within a decade. >> Yeah. So, it's possible. And Google is apparently now planning to team up with SpaceX for Project Sun Capture. >> Oh, wait. I thought they were always teamed up. Like they were always going to launch the things. Yeah, they were investigating it, but I feel like it's more official now. >> Okay, makes sense. >> But even SpaceX SpaceX's mega constellation is supposed to be 100 gawatt, which is not much, right? In the grand scheme of Oh, let's cut that out. >> I was going to say >> I was going to say I think that is really a lot. >> Yeah, that's like a 100 times colossus. Okay. >> I get Giga and Mega confused. >> No, I I do too. It's okay. >> It's gotten past like SpaceX and Google and there's even Venture Bets in the area. Like there's StarCloud which is already a unicorn. >> There's the Ocean Bet now >> there. Yeah. >> Yeah. >> No, I do think it's cool. Like I do think if we can harness these other places and take advantage of them, we Okay, that sounds really bad, but like we take >> like the aliens in space. We're like, "What the [__] bro?" Like >> no but not in that way of just like cuz I feel like we've never had the technology to explore these things in the level of depth that we are now. >> Yes. Obviously space would be nice because you have access to the sun all the time. >> Yeah. >> And you don't need to use a bunch of heat and water. >> It just like dissipates into the space. >> Yeah. That's what Elan said too. He was like there's no weather in space. >> Yeah. And we did a very technical deep deep dive on projects on catcher and I don't care to go over it again but you want to know how it works. >> You want to know about the TPUs and the light rays you can go back to that episode. >> Yeah, there's an episode where we literally talk about exactly how it all works. So we won't we will save that discussion for later. But >> yeah, and Sam Almond also thinks it's ridiculous. Just wanted to toss that in there. >> Is OpenAI not investing in data centers in space at all? >> Bro, they have so many data centers on the ground that aren't built yet. Start with that investment. >> Open eye does not have money to like start putting money into data centers in space. >> Why aren't they doing more internationally? Didn't we talk about this? I think it's like the power grid. >> Oh >> yeah. We honestly didn't even really get into the power grid in this episode. We've talked about it before, but our power grid can really not sustain this level of energy. >> And we're America. >> Sorry. >> No. Yeah. Like >> you're like think like Africa has a power grid that can support >> No. Yeah. Yeah. >> I'm sorry. >> Yeah. >> There's many problems cuz I need to build them now and they're not building here. >> Now. I want this now. >> Oh god. Okay. >> Yeah. Anyways. >> Anyways, on to China. >> Okay. >> China. Sorry to say. Okay. Okay, I feel like this is like tripping with tart for the tech world because Trump is off to China to meet Xi Jinping, but he's brought quite the entourage, including Elon. Who else is going? Tim Cook, Jensen Hong, >> yeah, all the big AI guys. >>

And basically, the idea is to stabilize USChina relations, which have obviously been tense over multiple issues, including trade. Within trade, there's been like a back and forth on rare earth minerals, on trade in general, on oil, on soybeans, planes, on chips. >> Chips is a big one. >> Chips is a big one. >> Yeah. Basically, we've been in a big fight with China and we were trying to solve it. And so, um, Trump basically was going to go out there to talk to Xi Jinping and they were going to figure out how to reach a ceasefire in Iran. Not necessarily that Iran was part of this discussion, but part of it was like, hey, buy some of the US oil. China, go tell Iran to stop being annoying and like open up the street of Hermas because um China and Iran have a very close relationships and China buys a lot of Iran's oil and so if they can weaken that relationship then Iran will be forced to hit a ceasefire and then in result we will have to give stuff up from the US and Xi Jinping really really wanted um us to like verbally concede on Taiwan and not necessarily like change anything about Taiwan but be like oh Taiwan like should go back to China because like the people in China really want that unification to happen again. >> You were going to say that, right? >> Yeah. I mean, the US always takes a neutral stance. >> The US always says that there's like one China, but there's just an underlying unspoken rule cuz like we do trade with Taiwan so much and like provide weapons to them. Like we do all of those things. >> Well, not even that. Like TSMC fulfills all of our orders o over China orders basically. And that's like something that they don't like. >> Yeah. And this was also a continuation of their conversation that they started last October. We talked about the tariffs a ton on this podcast and that was originally why like tensions were so bad at some point because of like the back and forth tariffs that we were putting on each other. And when they met last October, they the United States agreed to cut tariffs on Chinese goods by 10% bringing the average rate to 47%. And then on the other side there's all the rare earth minerals that we need from China. And so we had like bargained back and forth, but it wasn't officially put in place. And so this truce always needed to be revisited at some point. It was actually supposed to be revisited in April because of the Iran war. We had to push it out until I guess like last week. Um, and so that's why Iran became part of the conversation, but originally the conversation was all around like trade, what they actually were going to come to because basically the truce is over October of this year. So there needs to be something in writing, which there still isn't, by the way, but there needs to be something in writing by October. >> Yeah. And then the last thing planned for this meeting was also the um China US and China dialogue on AI safety. Like the two of them wanted to discuss how they were going to make sure that we don't blow up the entire planet. >> I'm a big fan of that. >> Yeah. >> I feel like people have become less pro cooperation >> just in general. >> I think so. Like >> I don't I didn't know that. I don't know. >> I don't know. Like I feel like when I read on on X like people's takes around AI and China and the race and stuff, it's very pro- US to the point of we shouldn't be talking to them at all. >> Yeah. It's also like not possible. Anyways, there were all these big grand plans for this meeting. I would say not a lot of them got accomplished. >> Yeah. >> And we can go into them. >> It doesn't seem like a lot got accomplished, but also I feel like it is difficult to tell from the news coverage cuz they're very like hush hush with what they actually put out there. It didn't get covered. It didn't get it didn't get covered much. And then also like the Chinese coverage is very different than the US coverage as well. And so there's a lot to untangle there of like what actually happened. But basically um I think what happened um at least what official what we officially know is that there are some planes that are bought. There are some agricultural trades and then China will buy some oil

from the US weakening the relationship with Iran a little bit. We did not say anything about Taiwan. However, the version that China got was that Taiwan was a very important topic and that we are trying to reach stability there in that more to come. So, it was like basically Xi Jinping like pitched what happened at the meeting as like we talked about Taiwan a lot and we are working on reaching stability there and getting what we want and trade was an afterthought versus Trump's version of the story is like trade was like the biggest part of the meeting. But yeah, and that makes sense for both countries and like why they pitched it as that. >> Yeah. Like Xi Jinping has said time and time again, Taiwan is the most important thing in the US-China relationship. And then he made a statement that quote Trump understands China's position that was kind of painted as a concession even though Trump didn't actually say anything. But then I felt like the biggest headline out of all of this was Xi Jinping saying that they're not going to do a ban on rare earth mineral exports to the US because they had paused it but it was technically still supposed to go into effect I guess a year from last time. So, October of this year, I'm actually I was actually thinking about it. I actually think Trump won a lot here and didn't give us >> I was going to say no news is good news for the US in my opinion. That's true. >> Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. >> I agree. Well, also because it seems like they are willing to cooperate on the whole Iran front. >> Well, the US and China came out of it on the same page like agreeing that the Strait of Hormuz should be open with no military commitment and that Iran shouldn't have nuclear weapons. So, >> I feel like that's as aligned as we can get with them. Yeah. And then on the AI safety topic there, they just said that they were working towards AI safety, but they didn't give any details. Um, but more specifically, like a couple days before this meeting on May 14th, the US commerce department approved 10 Chinese firms to buy Nvidia H200s, which if you didn't know, H200s are pretty powerful AI chips used for um like inference. You can't necessarily trade with these chips, but you can use them for inference. And uh the approved and the approved buyers are Alibaba, Tencent, by Dance and JD.com. And so these this is like a pretty big opening now for Nvidia to now start selling back into China. And Xi Jinping is not a fan of this because he wants Huawei to figure it out and be able to support all of the China economy for chips. But yeah, the whole thing is that he was a fan of the ban because he wanted >> he doesn't want them to have it. Well, he just wants to strengthen the Chinese chip power like Huawei something. Yeah. Like I feel like it is Huawei. Like they are the people that he would want to strengthen and compete with Nvidia. >> Yeah. >> But their reliance on us is actually good for us. >> Anyway, Jensen took a big W there. >> Jensen took a W. whoever the I think someone from Boeing was also there and on the Jetpoint like the stock actually tanked because apparently they were supposed to buy like 500 and then they only bought like 200 and I was like >> okay >> I don't really get what that was about. I couldn't understand it, but yeah. >> Yeah. >> Oh, I was going to say, did you guys see like the whole opening ceremony of Trump arriving? >> Yeah. Yeah. Air one. I know. And they were all like waving the flags. That's what I was about to talk about, too. >> Okay. Wait. Okay. Go ahead. Yeah. >> No, no, no. Like I saw it and it was so funny, too, because it was like the people walking out of Air Force One being like Trump, Elon, like all these people that like hate each other. >> Yeah. at this point in time. Just like thinking about them all flying together to China and then like coming off and being greeted by like hundreds of children just surrounding Air Force One, like it's crazy. >> That makes sense. But I think that's good. Like I think it like in their in those children's mind like the US and China are friends again. >> I feel like you don't have a lot to say on this one. >> Yeah. I don't really have

anything to say. >> That's so funny cuz I thought you would like cuz it's like political so I thought you would have like some >> political thoughts like your rants and stuff. I feel like nothing happened. >> Yeah, there I agree. >> Yeah. >> Yeah. >> No, I feel like nothing happened today. >> Like I felt like it was a nothing burger. You know how people say that. >> Yeah. >> But I think it's like >> like I feel like I have your thoughts on the data centers, honestly. Like I feel like that's actually something. >> No, I agree. >> Like I get how it's a big deal, >> but I Okay, I get how it's a big deal. I don't think it's that surprising. >> Yeah. >> And that's such a tough thing to do. like I feel like if it was like I'd be like, "Oh, this was probably so wellthought out, right? There was like hours of strategy that went into this. There's some chess game they're playing." Like Trump just likes being friends with people. He likes being on good terms. He [__] went to North Korea, too, at some point, didn't he? Like why are we like He went to China, >> but nothing actually happened. Yeah. Like I feel like I also think like in a way it actually strengthens his image in the States during the midterm elections. See like I don't even know if it does. >> No, I think it does cuz I think that Normie looks at it and it's like oh my god look he's like being friends with everyone and they're like that must be good. We're not going to have a war, >> right? Like think about the like the two second take from like seeing Trump go to China. Okay, China is our enemy and now Trump went to China and we're not enemies. Yay. Like that's how much thought I would >> I don't know. Like I feel like the average person would be like really upset we're in a war with Iran and unless it's over is not going to care and that looks really bad for him and doesn't really care about this China stuff. Like I feel like I almost barely paid attention to it. >> What percent of the country even knows that Trump went to China in the last two weeks if you ask them on the street? Like I'm not even sure I would know if it wasn't for the podcast. >> I saw like one tweet about it on like >> anyway we're here to cover. Sorry to disappoint. >> Yeah, we're here to cover >> we're here to we're here to cover the things that you wouldn't get anywhere else. >> Okay, well that's been a fun episode. Um >> we have we have a fun segment next >> insert insert segment here. But yeah, >> today we're sitting down with Ara Shahab, who's one of the co-founders of Amano, which is a hearing aid device. And one of the videos about it recently went super viral on X, getting 11 million views. And I feel like I've seen it on other platforms, too. So, congrats on all the success. I feel like from my perspective, it's really cool to see something like refreshing and new in tech that's like also would really help other people. And we're literally recording in the open evidence office, which is like also a healthcare company. So, excited to sit down and talk about it. You got to SF only like 3 weeks ago, right? >> It's been pretty crazy. Like, starting off it was a it was a new environment, new country and everything. and then kind of just, you know, got used to it and then things took a big turn after the video went out. So, it went a bit crazy after that. >> Yeah. So, the product, as I understand it, is basically that hearing aids on average cost something like \$4,700 and your guys' you're selling for \$19.99 and it only cost you a dollar to make. So, I'm curious, how did you decide on that product? And like what what is your background and like how did you end up here? >> For sure. Yeah. So coming into it, we all have a lot of family issues that come in hearing loss. Like one of my co-founders, his sister was born with hearing loss. And even with other with us, we have a lot of grandparents who have hearing issues as well. And like coming from a background from Pakistan, I feel that a lot of people don't have the resources and the and the money to be able to afford these hearing devices and which makes hearing actually a privilege rather than something that everyone should have. I've always been interested in

healthcare. I've always been interested in making a difference in the world and making people's lives better. I've done a lot of research with medical device systems. So I kind of knew I wanted to pivot to the side of making my own things in the future. Coming into university, I was a premed student. So coming into it, I knew that I wanted to do something related to medicine and it kind of started off as like a nonprofit journey and we realized that there could be more potential than this. So that's kind of how things took off. >> How did you guys come up with it? Like were you just talking about it one day and then you realized all three of you were interested in it or what was like the start of the company? >> We wanted to make something more accessible and more, you know, innovative as well at the same time. I remember I was sitting at my bed when I was in Boston. I was like thinking like I was on the call with Aaron and I was like what can we do to make an impact in the world and use our own capabilities to make something more impactful and we started going down this rabbit hole of finding something that's innovative and cool and could actually make a difference and we came across the hearing aid industry >> and I'm curious about the hearing aid industry as a whole. I know that uh Medicare did not cover hearing aids um since 1965. So why did that happen? And what is like the need in the market for hearing aids, but more specifically cheap hearing aids? >> Yeah, so currently like the biggest thing with hearing aids right now is that many people have over the counter hearing aids, but they're you can buy them from like Rexolaw or different armacies around the area, but they're not personalized. They're not custom fit and many times they have like a lot of disturbance. >> So ours mainly, we're not mainly going after like the big hearing aid companies. Ours is completely separate from those companies. And what we mainly do is make an affordable and more accessible option for people who can't afford them. Right now, from going from like the appointments to the clinic uh visits to the molding of the hearing aids, it costs around \$4,700. >> And insurance doesn't cover any of this. >> It varies from time to time, but um it depends on the country, depends on the hearing aid, depends on the pro provider, but it varies. Yeah. >> And why would why is it traditionally been so expensive? >> Um because like it requires a lot of different technologies to actually manufacture it and also um requires a lot of different visits to be able to actually create the hearing aid. Like for example, you have to go and mold it and then you have to get it fit to yourself and then you have to get adjusted and then there's a lot of like things that go here and there and plus it's easy to break the hearing aid. It's easy to lose it. So that's why insuranceances are a bit more reluctant to, you know, cover the full cost cuz it might come back to them. >> Okay. So it's not just making the hearing aid, it's like the maintenance of making sure it works for that personally. And correct me if I'm wrong, but like AirPods also can serve as a hearing aid or what's the difference between like a traditional hearing aid um that's produced by like a hearing aid company versus AirPods? >> So, from what I understand, AirPods are classified as over the counter hearing aids. So, they passed FDA approval recently as well in 2022 if I'm not mistaken. >> They do like a basic um hearing test as well to see what kind of hearing loss you have. And from there, you can kind of amplifies the sound based on exactly what kind of hearing loss you have. >> Okay. And so what is the difference between like an like the quality of an over-the-counter hearing aid versus like something personalized to you? Like I guess like walk me through like what a person of hearing loss might hear differently. >> There might be a lot more like clarity of sound in higher quality hearing aids as well as like removing that disturbance of background sound as well. Like for example, some hearing aids might overampy like very small minute like hitting a plate for example which is why many people

don't like typical hearing aids because they might over amplify certain sounds, right? So the more the more you pay, the more it'll decrease that background sound and the more it'll make that whole process more seamless for the user. >> Like there's still issues to the entire experience which make it frustrating to use essentially. And so do these people who have over the counter hearing aids just not use them full time? Like do they only use them selectively? Like what is the behavior there? >> It depends on person to person but some people like if they have like severe hearing loss it might not even work for them or if they might have different kinds of hearing loss it might not work for them. So it depends on the person how well they like the hearing aid itself cuz everyone you know has a different tolerance to it. And for example, some people might hear something very small and might take off the hearing aid right away. Other people might be able to, you know, abide by that. >> I read this stat that 40% of Americans who self-report hearing loss have hearing aids. That means 60% of Americans just don't have a hearing aid. Why why is that? Like why why why are people so reluctant overall? >> There's two different reasons that it could be is one of the biggest reasons is stigmatism around hearing aids. Having them something in your ear that you know makes you look a bit different than the regular person as well as the price. >> Okay. And so do a lot of hearing aids like a lot of the more expensive ones focus on being like indistinguishable? >> Exactly. Yeah. So a lot of the upcoming hearing aids are trying to be as invisible as possible so you can't really tell that there's actually hearing a device inside the patient's ear. >> Okay. >> And what's the technological unlock that you all figured out that makes it so much cheaper than the other ones on the market? So we kind of went back to like step zero and saw how the ear actually functions being a biomedical engineering major like a day before I landed an SF. I had my anatomy exam which I learned about the entire ear anatomy of it and I realized that you can actually apply that entire system into the hearing aid itself and make like a fully mechanical version just kind of replicating exactly how the ear functions. >> How the ear basically works is sound enters to the outer canal and enters into the ear canal where it hits something called the tympanic membrane. It's like it's like a barrier basically and when it hits that tympanic membrane it hits three different bones called the malleus, the incus and the stapes. And these three bones cause like vibrations to occur and then they pass that vibrations to the cochlea which allows you to be able to hear sound. >> Okay. >> So we kind of took those mechanisms of like the membrane and those the bones that act as lever systems and we kind of tried to replicate those and put it into our hearing aid. >> Okay. And what do most hearing aids do right now? Do they try to replicate that system? >> They mainly have like sound amplifiers. They have like microphones and different things that kind of take that sound and amplify it. But we we kind of went on it through a fully mechanical perspective and that's how the take we took our entire cell is 3D printed which is why what makes the cost a lot cheaper significantly. Another part of it is that basically sound enters it kind of mimics that tympanic membrane which I mentioned earlier and we have like our own tympanic membrane middle we have like a lever system that kind of you know triggers that mechanical advantage to it multiply over time and create that increase in um the sound that enters the ear and then we have another membrane system that kind of reamplifies the sound and enters into the patient's ear and >> have there been previous approaches to this problem in this way like has there been research that kind of underpins what you guys are doing >> if you go back to like like the very old times like the 1900 hundreds people did look into like like earphones for example like cones for example right and like people

did see like >> back in the day you used to use those those devices as hearing aids themselves >> right and >> wait sorry what do you mean >> like like if you take like a kitchen funnel for example back in the day many people used to use things like that as as hearing aids right so there has been studying studies done on how the shape of the mechanism can increase sound over time but no one has directly looked into how replicating the ear into a mechanical version could possibly amplify the sound itself. >> Why? Like why do you think people haven't >> I feel that it's a very like intricate system and everything is very small and precise in the human body. For example, the malleus incus and stapes they might sound like they're like pretty big bones but they're very very very small in the ear. So it's also very hard to replicate and mimic these bones that are in the body. But this is clearly a large problem and there's like very uh there's like companies making these hearing aids and so like I'm um I'm a little bit skeptical as to why like more people haven't really looked at this problem. Like what is why is it an unsexy problem? >> The biggest reason is because you won't reach the exact same or like you won't reach that same efficacy rate of a regular hearing aid. >> Okay. The re the main reason that is because you need to have those technologies inside the hearing a to be able to amplify that sound to say 100% of the user satisfaction and that closes a lot of the market down and that also closes your profit margins down by a lot as well. If you're targeting like the grand scope of people who have hearing loss, a lot of them will not sat be satisfied with a product that doesn't work as well as a typical hearing aid. But our main target is not to help the people who already have hearing devices, but the people who don't have the cost and the the money to be able to pay for those hearing aids themselves. >> Okay. So no one has ever cared to like basically aim for an 80 to 90% effect efficacy rate or at least what is your e efficacy rate? >> We don't have a set zone efficacy rate. We're still doing our testing. So we don't have like an efficacy rate to share yet. >> Okay. Okay. But you're but you're aiming on like potentially a lower e efficacy rate but but for a larger market. >> Exactly. Exactly. Right. So for example, for people who make those devices for people who can afford them, they keep adding like new technologies like noise cancellation or like reducing background sound. But many companies are looking down the route of like making refurbished devices, but it's still a harder market to tackle cuz there is still significant cost that go into it. >> The whole existing market is focused on making the person here the best, but not really making every person here. Okay, that makes more sense. And so I I'm curious like why haven't the over-the-counter models now also use this product or use this approach too? >> Um main reason is because they take it from a more electronic perspective cuz that's what's been working in the market so far and they take that perspective just using like more efficient products to use more cheaper products to use and putting that into more cheaper and more efficient product to sell to people. >> Okay. And so your entire product is purely 3D printed and there's no mechanical wiring in it. >> Exactly. There's no there's no wiring. electronics outer shell is 3D printed and the inside parts are by different materials. >> Okay. >> And so that's why it's so much cheaper. >> Exactly. >> How do you make sure it fits in a person's ear? Like how do you make sure it's customized for these? >> For sure. So we have an entire software component to the to the hearing aids themselves as well. So the patient they take a picture of their ear and using our system it kind of um maps out the entire ear itself and tells us exactly the points that are necessary to make their whole hearing aid custom fit to their ear. We kind of take all those points and make a custom fit version for their ear. I'm curious though like why not take like a 3D mold approach >> for sure. Yeah. So that would cost more money as well. At the same

time, say for example, we're targeting people in Pakistan, right? It's harder to be able to get that 3D mold from that person. It's harder to, you know, navigate that process. But a lot of people do have these devices where they can just take a picture of their phone. So it's a lot more efficient, a lot more affordable, a lot easier to get to that target market, which we want to target. >> I see what you're saying. And so your device only targets those of like hearing age with loss. I guess >> ours is specifically for like mild to moderate hearing loss. Whether that's like um >> you know like young adults or like people elderly people, but it's mainly for mild to moderate. One thing it's that we don't help with like tonitis or like severe hearing loss or like deafness, but we only specifically focus on that market. >> Okay. >> Why does it not work for those things from a technological perspective? I'm curious. >> So we can only increase like the decibel and the frequency um amplification by so much. it would still help them like very minimally but it won't help them like to to a crazy amount and with tonitis it can come with many different reasons. So sometimes it can be like um neurological sometimes it can be with age sometimes it can be because of damage. So there's a lot of reasons why that tenitis could be happening. So uh maybe we could solve it in some ways but not in every possible way that it stands for. >> Yeah that makes sense. And you're also starting somewhere and so there's like the potential to look at those areas after I think. >> Exactly. >> Yeah. How many people do you think have mild to me mild to moderate hearing loss but don't know? >> So I I would say like I would say a good amount of people have mild to moderate because it starts off very early and people you know they start seeing signs of it and they don't want to get it checked because it's mild they can still you know hear things here and there but from what I remember in like low middle income countries um a third of people who have hearing loss and don't have the resource for them they have mild to moderate hearing loss. Do you also feel like part of the problem is like hearing tests are inaccessible too? >> I would say so. Yeah, I would say what one thing is about like not having like the access to knowledge. So having more like accessible knowledge out there on why hearing care is important and why people should get their hearing checked and what other like neurological side effects it has from like when you start losing your hearing, what effects it has on your brain. So people kind of lose out on that and see that it might not be as big of a big of a problem. I don't know if this is crazy, but I kind of want to try it myself to be like, "Oh, does this make me hear better?" Like, "Maybe I do have this." Like, instead of even getting a hearing test, I'd be willing to just spend the \$20 to buy the product, >> right? Yeah. So, our um software as well has like a a basic level screen uh hearing test as well to screen for what kind of hearing loss you have and whether you would be eligible and what kind of category you would kind of fall into. So, we have that accessible platform so it can be done in that way as well. >> Okay. cuz like the hearing test I remember is like you go into some like really really dark room like it's like there's nothing there and then it's like some faint noise and so I I didn't know if it was possible to just do it through a phone. >> It of course it won't be as accurate like they do a lot more very specific testing which gets you exact results and um but similar to like like the AirPod test like they do also do like a like a base level test to see what kind of category you fall in kind of similar to that test. That's what we do. >> I see. Okay, that makes sense. Yeah, I was going to say like I feel like it's just like you wear headphones in a doctor's office and hear beeping, right? Which you could put through anything like for the it might not be as accurate, but yeah. I feel like I always do those video ones where it's like figure out when the frequency is high enough and you can't hear it anymore or something. So, >> really? >> Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. And I like I literally

like tap out at the first level. It's really bad. >> Really? >> Yeah. No, I've actually thought about >> I feel like my hearing is actually really good. >> Oh, >> like whenever I did the doctor's test. Oh, congrats. A star, gold star. >> What was it like to have the video go so viral? Like, were you guys expecting that? And what has it been like um just like I feel like you probably get a lot of like messages or like people interested now. >> Yeah, we weren't expecting it to go this viral. We were expecting it to get like, you know, a good amount of views, but not like 11 million views. But there's a lot been a lot of interest. It's been really nice going through them. um seeing how excited people are to try the product and how excited people are to see the the mission that we hold by. >> Is the next few weeks gonna kind of look like fulfilling those pre-orders and then going from there and like where in testing are you guys? Is there like I guess I'm not as familiar with like how these products launch. I imagine you have to do like some level of a trial or something. >> Yeah. So we have we tested our um V1 iteration back in Canada with an aiology booth at McMaster and now we're rolling out with our pilot program which we'll test on real people in clinics around the around the area and in back in Canada as well. Our pre-orders are subject to to vary because we have a lot of interest from international countries as well. So we want to roll out in batches and um just basically knock out a few countries first that we're are more local but that we can pass the regulations for and kind of go up from there. uh wrapping up next week with our um demo day which is on Friday. It's been like a great journey. They have like a huge hardware space, a hardware lab, one of the biggest in in the US itself and they've been providing a lot of resources in terms of manufacturing the the product itself, having the 3D printers on site, giving us mentorship through the entire process and then posting the video as well which went which went viral. >> I'm curious about the next three months like what do you expect like head like I guess walk me through the next three months like what are you guys going to be doing? Yeah. So, we're going to start fundraising soon as we need to um get a lot of 3D printers to be able to make a lot of devices and then from there kind of open up a facility, start doing a lot of different kinds of testing on patients in aiology booths. >> We've already gotten our our device looked at by different engineers and aologists and now we're just going to be rolling out on hardcore manufacturing. >> Okay. And is there any regulations that you have to pass with this or is it is it okay because it's just like a 3D printed object that people are opting to put in their ear? >> So it depends on the country that you're in, but majority of the time it passes as a class one medical device. Okay. >> So um >> what does that mean? >> So that there's three different tiers of devices. There's class one, there's class two, and there's class 3. Class one is the lowest severity, and in some countries it only takes like um a few weeks to to get and just not too much money to be able to get into your hand. So yeah, it doesn't take too long, especially if you're manufacturing yourself and you're also distributing itself yourself, it doesn't it doesn't take too long to get. >> And in in the US, how long does that take? >> Um, from what I understand, it takes around 2 to 3 weeks to get that um FDA class medical device approval. >> And then is the plan to stay in San Francisco or are you going to go back home to Canada or how are you thinking about that? >> We're still deciding that. Um, of course I would love to be with my family back in Canada, but I think for the time being I think it's best to fund raise when we're in San Francisco and kind of move things over to where the the the product is best fit and where the customers are in the next coming phase of the company. >> Okay. So what so San Francisco I guess I'm curious like what does it serve for you guys as a company? So, fun fact, San Francisco has the third largest or it's California, I'm pretty sure, or San Francisco, not sure

about the stat, but it's has one of the third largest hearing loss um populations in in the USA. >> Okay. Why do you know? >> I'm not too sure why. >> Okay. >> But but yeah, that is one of the things that's out there and there's a lot of resources through institutions and clinics in the area. So, that's one of the biggest pros as well. And there's also a lot of people doing cool stuff in hardware and you know just cool to see different perspectives on our on our new innovation. >> Yeah. I feel like San Francisco is definitely like a great ecosystem to build in, but sometimes it can be like lonely if you're not in like the SAS world where everyone just sort of spends their time. Exactly. >> But I get that. I'm curious. Do you also feel like the adoption rates are higher in San Francisco because people are just more primed to be like tech forward or just I I I would assume like San Francisco has like earlier adopters. >> I would say so. Yeah. I say I would say people wanting want want to try more innovative products and I would say like it makes the adoption rates higher because they're more willing to see new things come into play and you know kind of take risks. >> That's awesome. I my last question is around like how do you think about fundraising for something where like you're planning to also partner with NOS's and like low-income companies and how do you kind of sell that narrative to investors? Yeah. So we want to invest partner with investors who followed by followed by the same ethos and the same you know passion that we have for the for the company itself and you know who be willing to support us along that journey of us making an impact in the world and you know doing it for the for the love of the game rather than for the for what other effects it has. >> Yeah that's awesome. >> That's it. That's all I have. >> Awesome. Thank you so much for coming on. I'm excited to follow along and also congrats on all the success you guys already have had and also the demo day coming up. >> Thank you and thank you so much for having me on the show. >> Yeah, of course. Thank you.